



Pathway

A rejection should be a roadmap.

Explains why a loan was declined, finds the smallest realistic plan to get approved, shows when, and what it saves in rupees.

Why

What

When

₹ saved

EN • हि • मरा

TEAM

Vishwakarma gng

Viral Dhoka • Tanaya Thorat • Samarth Dhage



One Idea Can Impact a Billion Lives.

Pathway score

Declined

335

300

900

Approval needs

650

Chance of default in 2 years

87.7%

When

Approved in 18 months

The lowest-effort plan that flips the decision

→

Open lender report

→

Fairness audit

→

A rejection with no reason

Borrowers get a vague “no”. Regulators increasingly expect an explanation.



LOAN DECISION

“We regret to inform you that your application did not meet our credit criteria.”

Reason given: none

Next step: none

What many do next: an instant-loan app with hidden fees

Typical wording of a vague rejection

IN

RBI Fair Practices Code

Lenders should convey the main reasons for rejection in writing

IN

RBI Digital Lending Directions 2025

Key Fact Statement with APR and all fees before signing

EU

EU AI Act

Credit scoring is classed as high-risk AI (Annex III)

EU

GDPR Art. 22

Automated decisions need safeguards: human review, right to contest

US

Reg B (ECOA)

Adverse-action notice: specific reasons, or the right to request them

Who it helps, and how

Five groups, one engine. The borrower side is always free.

WHO	THEIR PROBLEM	WHAT PATHWAY GIVES THEM
 Declined borrowers First-time, thin-file, young, lower-income	"Rejected" with no reason or way forward	Plain-language reasons, a step-by-step plan, a timeline and the money saved
 Instant-loan users Tempted by app loans	Hidden fees and 7-day tenures hide 100%+ APRs	The true APR from real cash flows, red flags, where to report
 Big-loan planners Home, education, vehicle, business	Don't know the score they need, or if the EMI fits	Goal planner: required score, plan, milestones, affordability
 Lenders and NBFCs Banks, NBFCs, fintech lenders	Declined applicants are lost revenue; decisions must be explainable	Second-chance pipeline, rejection letters, fairness audit
 Regulators and NGOs Financial-literacy programmes	Hard to show how credit really works	A free, multilingual, transparent teaching tool

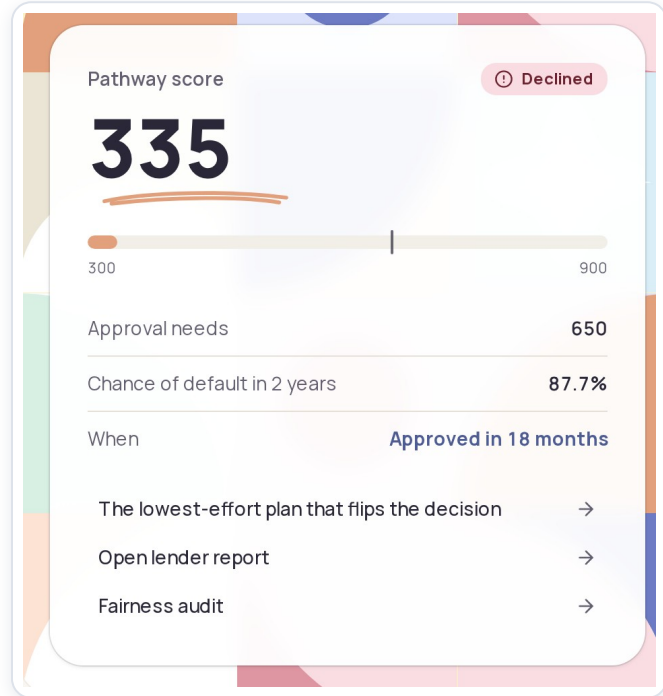
From rejection to roadmap

A real plan from the Pathway engine for a declined sample applicant, Asha.

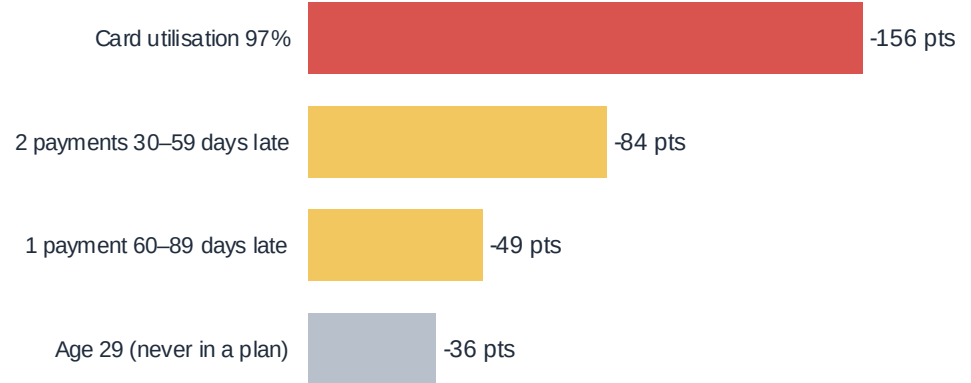


Why: every reason, in score points

Exact contributions from an interpretable model, ranked and written in plain words.



POINTS EACH FACTOR COSTS ASHA



Same reasons in English, Hindi and Marathi

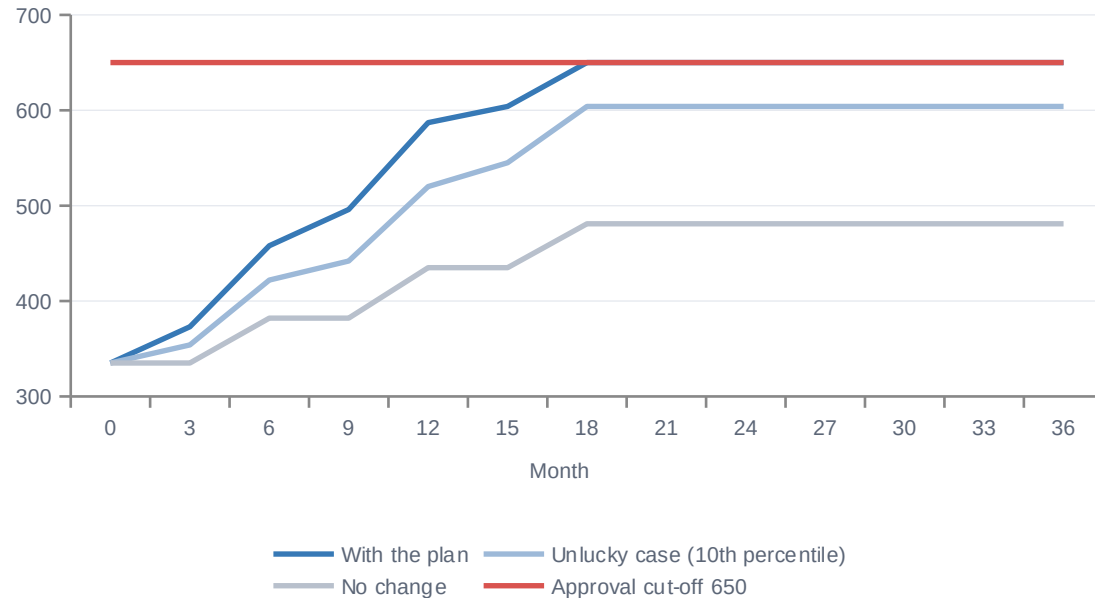


Printable rejection letter for lenders

When, and how sure

Month-by-month projection with a Monte Carlo range, not false precision.

ASHA'S PATHWAY SCORE BY MONTH



Month 18

LIKELY APPROVAL

Best case also month 18

Month 31

WORST CASE (90TH PERCENTILE)

with income shocks and new late payments

Never

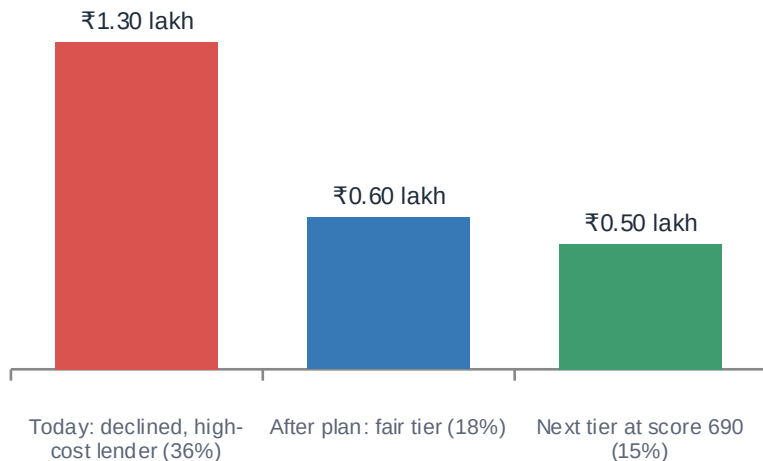
WITH NO CHANGE

Stalls at 481 even as old late payments age out

What the plan is worth in rupees

The same ₹2 lakh personal loan over 3 years: borrowed today versus after the plan.

TOTAL INTEREST PAID



EMI ₹9,161 → ₹7,230 → ₹6,933 a month

What the plan is worth in money

The same personal loan, taken today versus after the plan. Interest rates are illustrative, not offers.

Follow the plan and save ₹69,490 in interest

Your monthly payment (EMI) drops by ₹1,930 a month.

Loan amount

₹ 200,000

Term

12 mo

24 mo

36 mo

48 mo

60 mo

₹50,000

₹25 lakh

Borrow today

Interest rate (p.a.)

36%

Declined: high-cost lender at 36% a year

Monthly payment (EMI)

₹9,161

Total interest

₹1,29,787

Borrow after the plan

Interest rate (p.a.)

18%

Fair tier

Monthly payment (EMI)

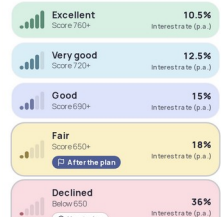
₹7,230

Total interest

₹60,297

Illustrative rate ladder

A higher Pathway score unlocks a lower rate.



Pricing assumptions (illustrative)

₹69,490

less interest, and ₹1,930 a month lower EMI.
A 40-point push to 690 saves ₹10,707 more.

Rates are illustrative risk-based tiers (10.5%–18% approved, 36% high-cost alternative), shown next to every figure on the site.

Offer check: the true cost of instant loans

Enter any loan offer; Pathway works out the real yearly rate from the actual cash flows.

The true cost

True APR

1,293%

Yearly rate including every fee, worked out on the money you actually receive.

Effective annual rate (compounded) : > 10,00,000%

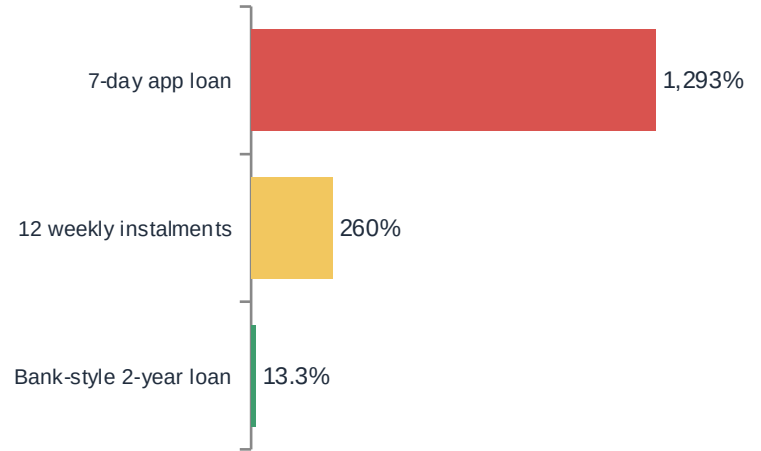
You get ₹4,115 and pay back ₹5,250 over 7 days. That is ₹1,135 for the use of the money: a true APR of 1,293%.

Cost verdict

⚠️ Predatory-level cost

Above 100% a year: at this rate, a year of borrowing would cost more than the money you received. Look at other options first.

TRUE APR OF THREE EXAMPLE OFFERS



Fictional offers built into the site. The 7-day loan: ₹5,000 sanctioned, ₹4,115 received after fees and GST, ₹5,250 repaid.



Red flags: fees taken upfront, tenure under 60 days, APR over 36% (warning) or 100% (danger)



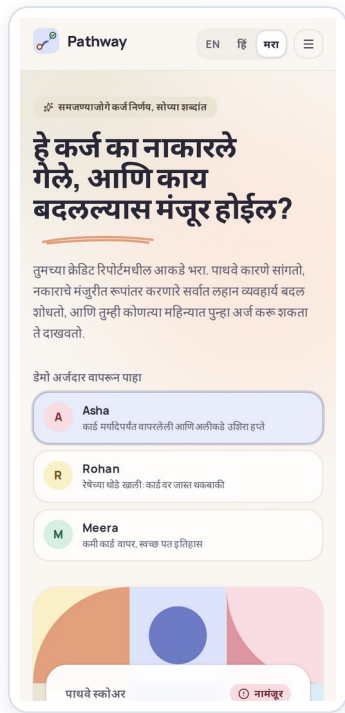
What to do: ask for the Key Fact Statement; report fraud on Sachet or call 1930



Runs in your browser: nothing you type is stored or sent

Built for Bharat

Phone-first, in three languages, with no sign-up needed to get a plan.



मराठी



हिंदी



English, हिंदी, मराठी

Every reason, plan and letter, in Indian terms: FOIR, DPD, EMI, lakh



Phone-first and light

Works on low-end phones; most features run in the browser



Private by design

No tracking cookies; Google sign-in is optional, only to save plans



Goal planner

₹2 lakh at $\leq 15\%$? Asha needs 690 and gets there in 18 months, EMI ₹6,933



Lender letter in Hindi

Printable rejection letter with reasons, plan and timeline

Results across 608 declined applicants

The shipped engine, run on every applicant the model declined in a 3,000-person hold-out sample.

0.856

MODEL AUC

30,000-applicant hold-out

87%

APPROVED WITHIN 12 MONTHS

median 12, average 9 months

₹70,004

AVERAGE INTEREST SAVED

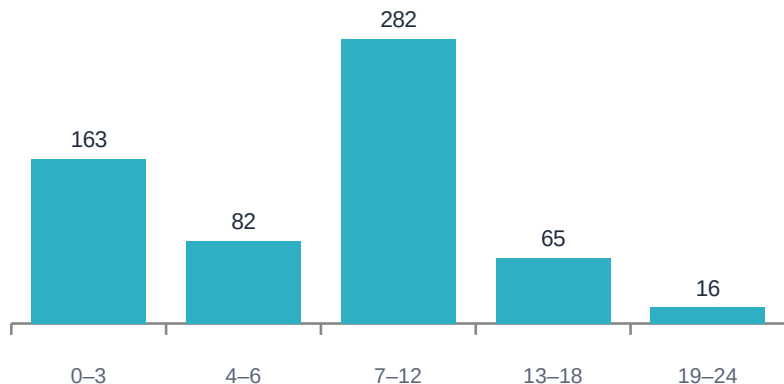
per ₹2 lakh, 3-year loan

99%

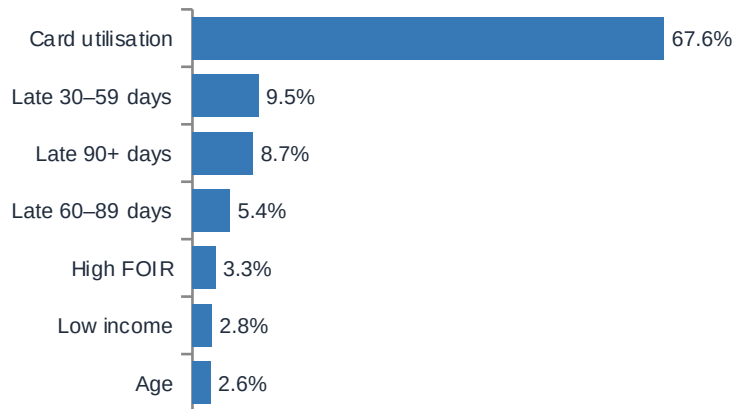
AVG. MONTE CARLO APPROVAL

of 400 futures, within 36 months

MONTHS TO APPROVAL (APPLICANTS)



TOP REASON FOR THE DECLINE (% OF 608)

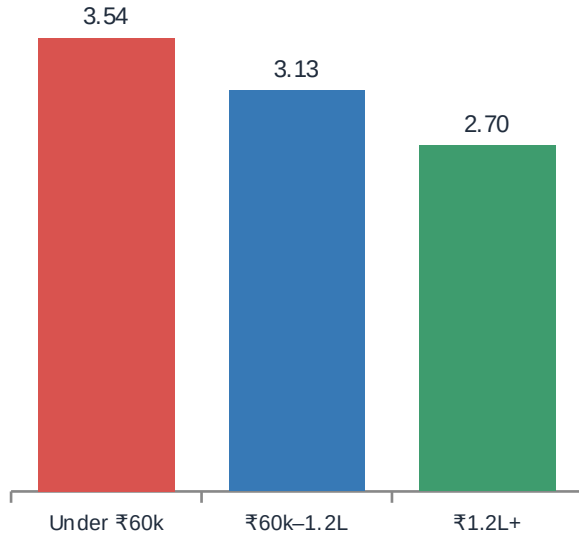


All 608 got a plan that reaches approval within the 36-month cap. Model trained on 120,000 records in the Kaggle "Give Me Some Credit" format; a pilot recalibrates on lender data.

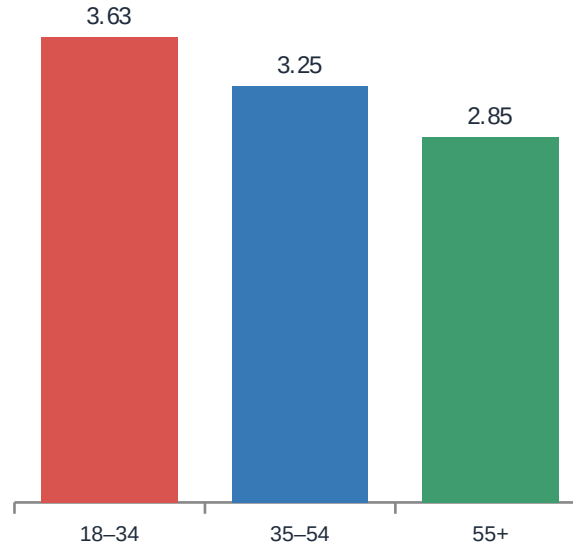
Fairness: who has to work harder?

Recourse effort compared at the same risk level, so the gap is not just “riskier people need more”.

BY MONTHLY INCOME



BY AGE



31%

INCOME GAP

more effort under ₹60k vs ₹1.2L+

27.6%

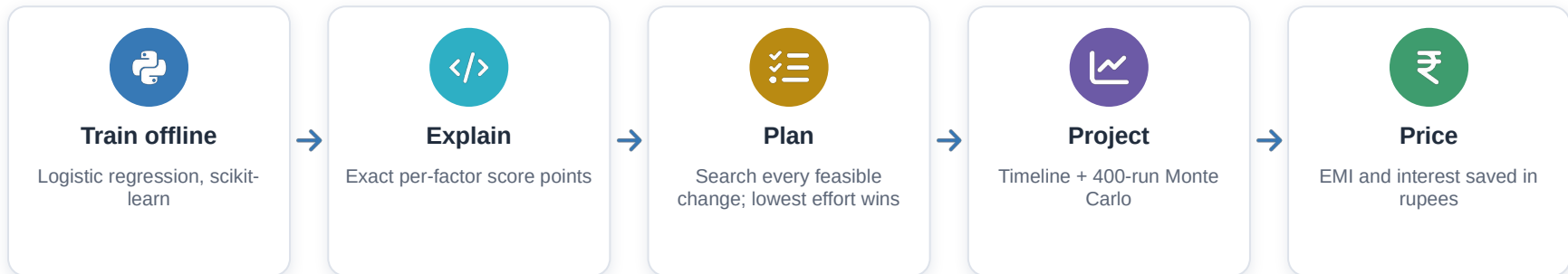
AGE GAP

more effort at 18–34 vs 55+

Lenders see the gap, by group, in the fairness audit and can act on it.

How it works

An interpretable model, trained offline, drives a fast and fully explainable engine.



Framework	Next.js 16, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind 4, shadcn/ui
Model	Python → JSON coefficients → TypeScript inference (no GPU)
Accounts	Optional Google sign-in via Supabase, row-level security
Security	Strict CSP and headers, same-origin, rate-limited API

155

TESTS PASSING

unit and property tests

0

GPUS NEEDED

inference is a few lines of arithmetic

Why Pathway, not the alternatives

Others explain the score or sell the loan. Pathway plans the way from “no” to “yes”.

	Credit-score apps	Credit-repair firms	Loan marketplaces	Explainable-AI vendors	Pathway
Reasons for a specific decision	Partly	Partly	No	Partly	Yes
Exact step-by-step plan	No	Partly	No	No	Yes
Timeline with a confidence range	No	No	No	No	Yes
Money impact in rupees	No	No	Partly	No	Yes
Free for borrowers	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes
Hindi and Marathi	Partly	Partly	Partly	No	Yes
Fairness audit for lenders	No	No	No	Yes	Yes

“Partly” = generic or manual. Typical public offerings by category (e.g. CIBIL, Experian, CRED; Paisabazaar, BankBazaar; Zest AI, FICO tools). Individual products vary.

Business model: free for borrowers, paid by lenders

Lenders gain because today's declined applicants become tomorrow's approvable customers.

REVENUE STREAM	WHO PAYS	INDICATIVE PRICE
 Decline-to-Approve API / widget	Banks, NBFCs, fintechs	₹5–20 per decline served
 Second-chance referral	Lenders	₹300–1,500 per funded loan
 Compliance and fairness module	Lenders, auditors	Annual licence
 Premium tracking and reminders	Individuals (core stays free)	₹49–99 a month
 CSR, NGO and government	Financial-literacy programmes	Programme fees

ONE LENDER PARTNER, ONE YEAR

2 lakh declines served × 2% re-approved

₹52 lakh

Pathway revenue

₹20 L decline fees + ₹32 L referrals

4,000 loans

second-chance loans funded

≈ ₹80 crore disbursed at ₹2 lakh each

₹24 crore

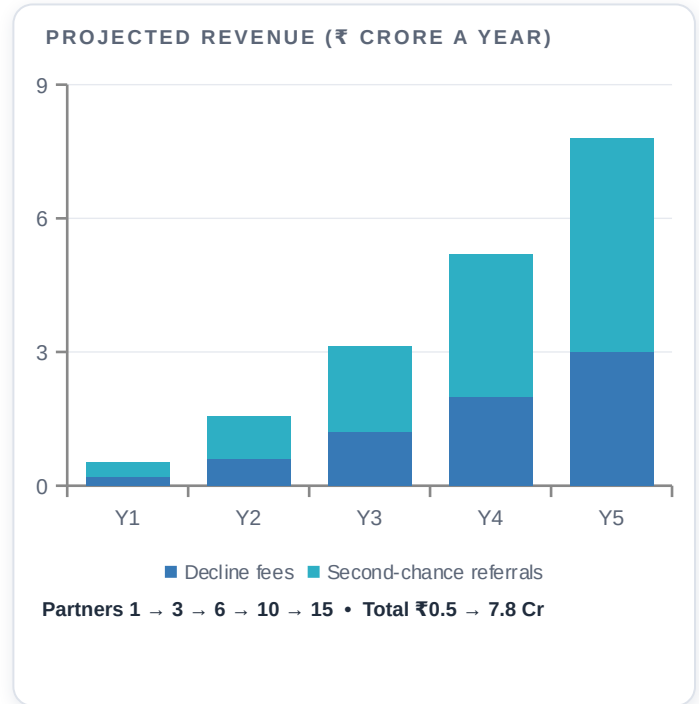
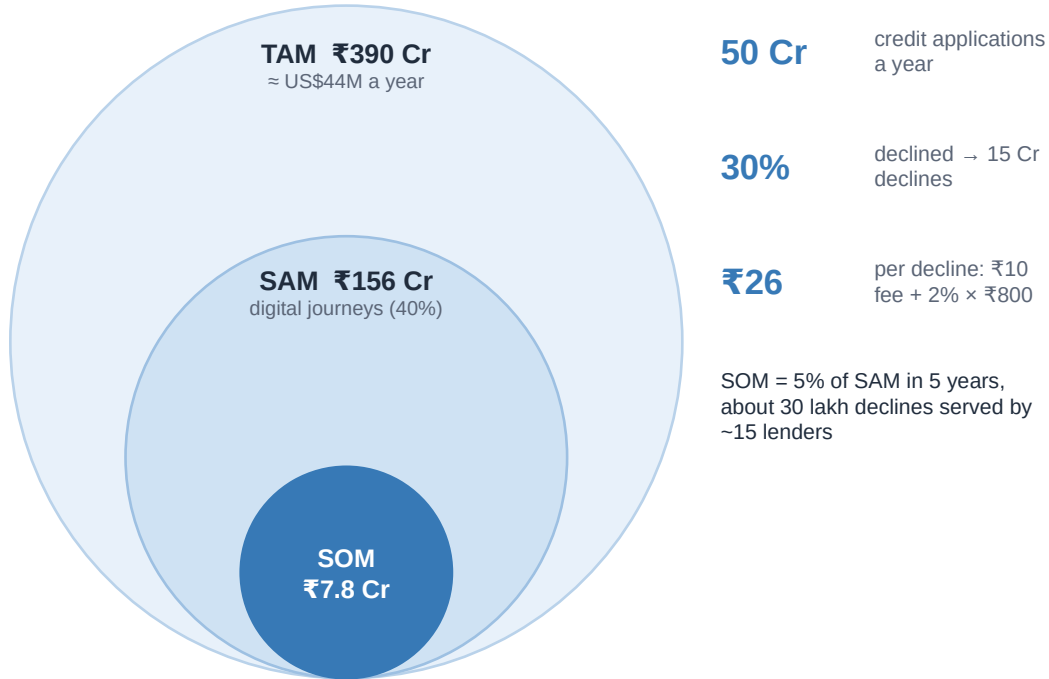
lender's gross interest income

₹60,297 per loan at 18%, before losses

Projection from stated assumptions: ₹10 per decline, 2% conversion, ₹800 per funded loan. Prices are indicative; none have been agreed with a lender yet.

Market size and 5-year projection

India first, sized from stated assumptions. Each input is listed so it can be checked.



Working estimates. Not counted: compliance licences, consumer premium, CSR, and the same engine for EU AI Act and US Reg B markets.

Roadmap, team and ask

From a working product to a lender pilot.

NOW

Live MVP

- 7 tools live, EN/HI/MR
- 155 tests passing
- Accounts and saved plans

0-3 MONTHS

Real data

- Retrain on real credit data
- Borrower user tests
- WhatsApp reminders

3-9 MONTHS

Lender pilot

- One NBFC or fintech
- $\approx$ 2 lakh declines a year
- Measure re-approvals

9-24 MONTHS

Scale

- Account Aggregator cash flows
- Public API, more languages
- 3 $\rightarrow$ 6 lender partners

TRY IT LIVE



pathway-credit-recourse.vercel.app

Scan to see a rejection become a roadmap.

github.com/viralala/pathway-credit-recourse

TEAM

Vishwakarma gng

Viral Dhoka
Tanaya Thorat
Samarth Dhage

OUR ASK

A pilot lender or fintech, access to real credit data under NDA, and mentors in lending and compliance.